

Essay on Pakistan's Capital City: Islamabad

Islamabad, the capital city of Pakistan, stands as a symbol of national unity, peace, and progress. Known for its natural beauty, clean environment, and modern infrastructure, Islamabad represents the country's vision for a planned and well-developed metropolis. It is one of the most beautiful capital cities in the world, attracting visitors with its calm atmosphere, greenery, and scenic landscapes.

Historical Background

Before Islamabad was built, Karachi served as the capital of Pakistan. In the late 1950s, the government decided to establish a new capital that would be centrally located, well-planned, and secure. After careful consideration, the area near the Margalla Hills was selected. The Greek architect and town planner **Constantinos A. Doxiadis** designed the master plan of Islamabad in 1960.

In 1967, Islamabad officially became the capital of Pakistan. The establishment of the city marked a major step in the country's developmental path, as it was designed to host major government institutions, foreign embassies, and residential sectors.

Geography and Location

Islamabad is located at the foot of the beautiful **Margalla Hills**, which form part of the Himalayan foothills. Its strategic location provides pleasant weather, lush green views, and natural protection. The city covers an area of approximately 906 square kilometers and borders Rawalpindi, forming the "Twin Cities."

City Planning and Infrastructure

Islamabad is known for its **well-planned design**, divided into different sectors arranged in an organized grid pattern. Each sector is labeled with alphabets and numbers, making navigation easier. The city includes:

- Residential sectors
- Commercial areas
- Diplomatic Enclave
- Government offices
- Educational institutions

- Parks and recreational spaces

Wide roads, modern buildings, and green belts reflect the city's focus on urban planning and environment-friendly development.

Important Landmarks and Institutions

Islamabad is home to several significant national and international landmarks:

1. Faisal Mosque

The iconic symbol of Pakistan's capital, Faisal Mosque is one of the largest mosques in South Asia. Its unique architecture and peaceful surroundings attract tourists from around the world.

2. Pakistan Monument

Located on Shakarparian Hills, the monument represents the four provinces and three territories of Pakistan. The Pakistan Monument Museum preserves history and national heritage.

3. Parliament House & Supreme Court

Islamabad hosts all major government institutions, including the Parliament, Presidency, Prime Minister House, and Supreme Court.

4. Daman-e-Koh & Pir Sohawa

These viewpoints offer breathtaking views of the entire city and are popular picnic spots.

5. Lok Virsa Museum

A cultural center that showcases Pakistan's traditional art, crafts, and heritage.

Education and Research

Islamabad is a major center of education in Pakistan. Some of the country's top universities are located here, including:

- **Quaid-i-Azam University (QAU)**
- **National University of Sciences & Technology (NUST)**
- **International Islamic University Islamabad (IIUI)**
- **COMSATS University**

- **Air University**

These institutions attract students from across the country and contribute to research, technology, and national development.

Economy and Lifestyle

Islamabad has a growing economy driven by government administration, education, IT, real estate, and tourism. The city hosts many multinational companies, modern shopping malls, restaurants, and hotels. Its peaceful lifestyle, low crime rate, and clean environment make it an ideal place for living.

Natural Beauty

One of Islamabad's greatest strengths is its natural beauty. The city is surrounded by greenery, hills, forests, and lakes. Popular natural attractions include:

- **Rawal Lake**
- **Shakarparian Park**
- **Trail 3, 5, and 6 (hiking trails)**
- **Lake View Park**
- **Margalla Hills National Park**

The city's commitment to preserving nature makes it one of the greenest capitals in the world.